

# Five bold ideas that could shake up IPL!

T20 cricket is evolving fast! From **all-spin attacks** to playing without a wicketkeeper, here are five bold strategies that could redefine the IPL and push the game's limits.

**Dhruva Prasad and Pranay Rajiv**

dhruva.prasad@thehindu.co.in

pranay.rajiv@thehindu.co.in

**T**he IPL 2025 season is set for a shake-up with two major rule changes — bowlers can once again use saliva on the ball, and a second ball will be introduced after the 11th over of the second innings to tackle the dew factor.

While these tweaks aim to balance the game, here are five more potential strategic innovations that teams could follow to make the league even more thrilling.

## **All-spin attack**

Earlier this year, Paarl Royals pushed the boundaries of T20 bowling strategies by becoming the first team to use only spinners for all 20 overs during an SA20 match against Pretoria Capitals.

The Royals deployed Bjorn Fortuin, Dunith Wellalage, Mujeeb Ur Rahman, Ngqabayomzi Peter and Joe Root as their sole bowling options, securing an 11-run victory.

Given how much more favourable Indian conditions are for spinners, it seems only a matter of time before

an IPL team follows this blueprint.

Chepauk's historical preference for spinners makes Chennai Super Kings an ideal candidate to experiment with the all-spin ploy. CSK also has five top-quality spin options at its disposal – Ravindra Jadeja, R. Ashwin, Noor Ahmad,

Rachin Ravindra and Shreyas Gopal – should it choose to go down that route.

## **Flipping the batting order**

It is not uncommon for cricket to borrow ideas from one format to another. A glance at the recently concluded Ranji Trophy final offers the IPL a potential tactical innovation.

After being inserted by Kerala on a pitch with a green tinge, Vidarbha flipped its batting order to shield its in-form top order from the new ball.

The strategy worked well, as Vidarbha posted 379 in the first innings and went on to claim the title by securing the first-innings lead.

This could be a viable game plan against teams with a formidable PowerPlay bowling attack. Mumbai Indians, with Jasprit Bumrah, Trent Boult, Deepak Chahar and Mujeeb Ur Rahman, are the most obvious example.

In such situations, teams could send in lower-order batters to attack from the outset, neutralising the opposition's advantage and allowing their best batters an



SPORTSPICS